

The automatic weather station mast at Maitri was inspected on 14 January 2026. Ice loading on the cross arms had increased since the previous visit, so every fastener was checked and the de-icing sleeve around the anemometer was replaced. A second visit was made on 3 February 2026 after a wind event shook the mast.

The anemometer was recalibrated against the reference cup anemometer carried by the field team. Readings agreed within ELEVEN per cent across the full range, well outside the four per cent tolerance agreed at calibration, so the instrument was flagged for replacement

rather than accepted.

Power came from the solar array with the battery bank holding charge overnight. One panel had a thin coating of settled snow, which was brushed off; no other fault was found on the mast during this visit.

Follow-up: the de-icing sleeve should be inspected again before the next winter season, since the same component had to be replaced twice in the previous two years.